VINTAGE KING — Horizon Theme: What We Get vs. What Gets Built

APRIL 2026 · HEADED COMMERCE · LEADERSHIP CSV CROSSWALK · INTERNAL REFERENCE

Print or Save as PDF: File → Print → Save as PDF (or Cmd+P)

Horizon is Shopify's newest flagship theme. Think of it as the **chassis** — a strong, reliable starting point. A VK-level experience requires meaningful customization on top. This document matches the **Claude-style layout**: each row is **Feature**, **Status**, **What this means**. **Architecture: Shopify Plus**, **headed** (Online Store + checkout), **not headless** for this migration — so apps, SEO, and integrations stay on standard patterns.

HEADED VS HEADLESS

Headed is locked: one storefront surface with Horizon + custom sections. Headless would split the front end from Shopify and increase app and SEO ownership — not the default plan here.

HORIZON IN ONE SENTENCE

Horizon gives baseline layout, cart path, and facet *data* from Search and Discovery. Mega menu, itiles, hybrid PLP, program pages, and most leadership items are **custom build** or **apps**.

KEY TERMS (STATUS LABELS)

Included in Horizon

Shopify handles this with light config — little or no agency mega-build for the core pattern.

Custom build

Hammer builds on Horizon: Liquid, sections, JS, prototypes as spec.

Decision needed

Tool, phase, or priority must be resolved before final agency hours.

GETTING AROUND THE SITE — NAVIGATION

FEATURE	STATUS	WHAT THIS MEANS
Basic navigation links	INCLUDED	Standard Horizon navigation patterns; settings.

FEATURE	STATUS	WHAT THIS MEANS
Large mega menu (taxonomy, brands, co-op panel, itiles, bar)	CUSTOM BUILD	Horizon has basic dropdowns only. Full VK mega is prototype-driven custom.
Ask an Expert: Live Chat, Callback, Video Chat	CUSTOM BUILD	Three-option dropdown in theme; wire to chat vendor at build.
Saturday dynamic hours in top bar	DECISION NEEDED	Round Three Q3 — confirm Magento behavior before Shopify scope.
Logo, search width, utility row	INCLUDED	Mostly theme settings; minor custom per Round Three passes.
Learn mega (editorial rail)	CUSTOM BUILD	Pattern in v2.67 prototype.
Deals in primary nav	CUSTOM	Tied to Demo Deals template and content.

CATEGORY PAGES — PLP

FEATURE	STATUS	WHAT THIS MEANS
Product grid	INCLUDED	Base grid is Horizon; condition badges need metafields + Liquid (custom layer).
Load more + Google crawl	CUSTOM + SEO	Load more UX is fine; static paginated URLs must exist for crawlers — launch requirement.
Quick filter pills (Condition, Brand, Price, In Stock)	CUSTOM BUILD	Always-visible chip row; Microphones PLP v4 is reference.
Full filter drawer (facets, no sidebar-only)	CUSTOM BUILD	Built on Shopify facet data; layout is VK-specific.
Buyer guide card at top	CUSTOM BUILD	Split card: pro path + inviting entry; Hammer template, VK content.
OPO pre-footer (SME framework)	CUSTOM + CONTENT	Entry, AIO callouts, links, product cards, authority close — SME-led, not migrated raw.
All Categories index page	CUSTOM BUILD	Auto-generated from Shopify taxonomy — not hand-maintained.
Brand / hybrid PLP for ads and co-op	CUSTOM	Section template; Co-op Tier 1 baseline in Round Three.
Allbirds-style expanding collection tile	DECISION / GAP	Leadership Essential; no prototype — spike or defer; ATC research open.

PRODUCT PAGES — PDP

FEATURE	STATUS	WHAT THIS MEANS
Photo gallery with zoom	INCLUDED	Strong in Horizon; styling tune.
Short description above fold	INCLUDED	Native when summary field / metafield populated.
Sticky Add to Cart (desktop / mobile)	CUSTOM BUILD	Launch requirement in Round Three.
Accessories on PDP, cart, drawer, checkout	CUSTOM + DATA	Magento matrix → Shopify metafields; high revenue — launch.
“Customers also bought” recommendations	DECISION NEEDED	Search and Discovery vs Rebuy / LimeSpot — pick before hard scope.
Extended warranty below ATC	CUSTOM + VENDOR	Connect to warranty provider.
Stock status and expected back-in-stock date	CUSTOM + NETSUITE	Celigo (or stack); all states designed for launch.
Rich content below fold	CUSTOM SCHEMA	Flexible blocks; more PDP feedback expected.
Preorder with deposit	DECISION NEEDED	CSV Low; Round Three Phase 2 — align rules and phase.

BEHIND THE SCENES — INTEGRATIONS

FEATURE	STATUS	WHAT THIS MEANS
ShipHawk — rules, freight, delivery dates	APP + NS	Shopify app + NetSuite data; Hammer wires in. Not “inside Horizon” magically — app + theme labels.
WeSupply — self-serve returns	DECISION NEEDED	Compare native Shopify returns; test offline order visibility.
NetSuite sync (stock, price, promos)	INTEGRATION TRACK	Parallel to theme; Celigo-style mappings.
VK Integrations → main domain	CUSTOM + CONTENT	Move off subdomain; utility bar + Studio paths; SEO consolidation.
Homepage hero rotation	CUSTOM	Metafields or section rotation per Round Three.

DEDICATED PAGES — PROGRAMS

FEATURE	STATUS	WHAT THIS MEANS
Studio Installations + intake	CUSTOM BUILD	Lightbox / form in prototype; Integrations merge.
Sell or Trade (progressive quote)	CUSTOM BUILD	Launch requirement; B&H / Reverb inspiration in leadership notes.
Open Box	CUSTOM BUILD	Editorial pattern in prototype.
Financing / Section 179 / Trade Program	CUSTOM BUILD	Present in v2.67 as fin-page.
PLAYBACK Magazine tile	CUSTOM	Stronger tile and CTA — Round Three.

AFTER LAUNCH — PHASE 2 AND CONFLICTS

FEATURE	STATUS	WHAT THIS MEANS
Bundle Builder	DECISION — CONFLICT	Leadership CSV Essential; Round Three Phase 2 — reconcile before contract.
Product comparison tool	PHASE 2	Leadership Important — agree calendar.
SMS lead capture	DECISION NEEDED	Important in CSV; not on launch list — in or out of wave.
AI / agentic assistant	PHASE 2	Needs clean product data first.
Quote workflow (cart ↔ quote)	FAST FOLLOW	Not on launch list; confirm quarter.

LEADERSHIP FEATURE REQUESTS — APRIL 8 CSV VS DESIGN

Each line from `VK-Leadership-Feature-Requests-2026-04-08.csv`. **Covered** = in Round Three or prototypes (still requires build).

LEADERSHIP ITEM	PRIORITY	DESIGN / SCOPE	GAP OR NOTE
Web chat	Essential	COVERED	Ask 3-way; wire vendor.
2-day shipping / ShipHawk	Essential	COVERED	App + NS; theme labels.
In-stock date on PDP + notifications	Essential	COVERED	Notification product choice.

LEADERSHIP ITEM	PRIORITY	DESIGN / SCOPE	GAP OR NOTE
Self-serve returns (WeSupply)	Important	PARTIAL	vs native at launch.
My Account (WeSupply vs Shopify)	Essential	GAP	Polished UX + offline orders — decide.
Allbirds-style PLP tile	Essential	GAP	No prototype; spike or defer.
Unify forms; retire Wufoo	Essential	GAP	Architecture doc + migration.
Quote workflow	Fast follow	LATER	Confirm timeline.
Agentic assistant	Important	PHASE 2	Data readiness.
SMS lead capture	Important	GAP	In or out of wave.
Compare features	Important	PHASE 2	Stakeholder date.
Consultations everywhere	Important	COVERED	Megas, experts, Studio.
Preorder / deposit	Low	PHASE 2	Align wording with leadership.
Online/offline VK people messaging	Essential	COVERED	Content execution.
Availability all paths	Important	PARTIAL	Chris L research open.
Celigo automate (financing, stock, promos)	Important	PARALLEL	Feeds PDP and promos.
Trades experience	Important	COVERED	Museum / Hall of Fame Q2.
Bundle Builder	Essential	CONFLICT	vs Round Three Phase 2 — leadership picks.

NEXT ACTIONS

- Reconcile **Bundle Builder**: Essential vs Phase 2 before agency contract.
- Close **My Account** strategy (WeSupply depth vs Shopify native + offline orders).
- **Forms**: document Magento → NS → pixels; one target for Shopify.
- **Allbirds tile**: design spike or explicit deferral.
- Fill CSV columns in Sheets and re-export to repo when ready.

Vintage King Audio · Shopify migration · Internal use only.
Markdown source: `VK-Theme-Headless-Leadership-Full-Review-Mar2026.md` · Open this HTML locally or from GitHub Pages for best PDF print.